attack. It was the most barbaric of acts and what was happening in the streets of Mumbai was shocking. These were places that were part of our daily existence. It was devastating to see flames coming out of the Taj Mahal Palace Hotel, one of India's iconic landmarks. I anxiously called Anjali to check that she and all our friends and loved ones were safe.

What made it all even more personal was that, just the day before, Anjali had been in Leopold's restaurant, which was one of the prime targets, and had also visited another target, the Oberoi, for dinner the previous night. She had gone to see a play at the National Centre for the Performing Arts and ended up having dinner with her friends there. She could so easily have been caught up in the mayhem.

The terror attack continued the next morning and the pictures were beamed live all day on 27 November 2008. We had a team meeting and were informed that England had decided to call off the series and had already left for Dubai. It was understandable, because none of us was in a frame of mind to play cricket. I returned to Mumbai that evening and was met by security personnel at the airport, who escorted me home. It was unnerving to think that it was all happening so close to where I lived. I was angry and upset and it was a horrible feeling having to sit back and pray for the ordeal to end.

A week after the terror attacks, it was announced that England were coming back for a two-Test series. This was a terrific gesture and each one of us appreciated the efforts of the English to return to India within two weeks of the carnage. While nothing could compensate for the trauma inflicted by these terror strikes, a resumption of cricket was a welcome sign for us all.

Cricket for peace

When we assembled in Chennai for the first Test on 11 December we were still finding it difficult to concentrate on cricket. Our thoughts were with the victims of the attacks and everyone was talking about those traumatic three days. But we had a Test match on our hands and we felt it was important for all our fans that we should put in a good peformance in Chennai.

England started well, with captain Andrew Strauss becoming the first England player to make a century in both innings on the subcontinent and Paul Collingwood also making a century. Unless we managed to pull